

festival

Monsoon Magic

DELHI There is some magic in the monsoon season. It inspires musicians, dancers, artistes and poets to create. Perhaps the rain motivates creation and rejuvenation which makes everyone long for this season after the dry humid spell. And Raga Malhar has the most vivid association with the monsoon. It is believed that legendary musician Tansen rendered Raga Megh Malhar to invoke the rain gods.

The Indian Council for Cultural Relations brings Malhar, a four-day festival, to celebrate the spirit of the monsoons. On the opening day, Sharmishtha Mukherjee presents Varsha Mangal in the Kathak tradition. Her choreography will showcase the different aspects of the monsoons—romantic, destructive and creative—and will be supported with multi-

Mukherjee (above); Mudgal (below) and Gurinder

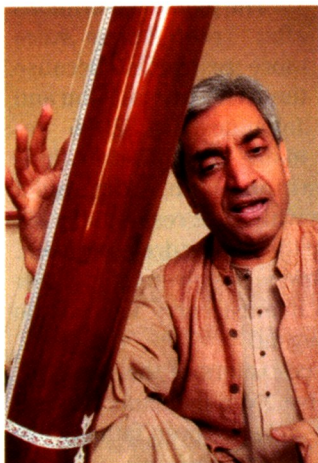
media and video images. "I have tried to make a personalised statement through my creations within the Kathak dance form," says Mukherjee, who will also be dancing to a composition from the band Indian Ocean.

The following day Madhup Mudgal and Gurinder Harnam Singh present vocal recitals. An intellectual musician, Mudgal—in spite of having a strong influence of many gurus on his gayaki—has developed his own original and soulful style. He will sing the famous traditional

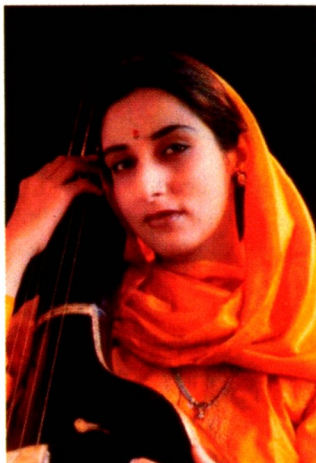
composition in Raga Mian Ki Malhar, *Karim naam tero* and other Malhar compositions of his guru Kumar Gandharva.

Gurinder, a disciple of Kishori Amonkar, makes a rare appearance on the concert stage. She is likely to sing shabad in Raga Malhar from the Sikh holy book, Guru Granth Sahib. The last day features T.R. Dhandapanay (percussion) and G.S. Rajan (flute). At Kamani Auditorium from August 6-9.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



BANDEEP SINGH



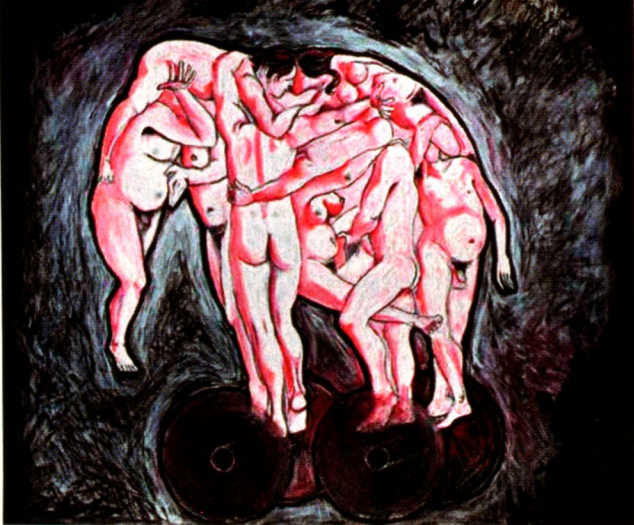
exhibition

Pink Pursuits

MUMBAI Celebrating the abundance of the colour pink in our lives comes 'Pink', an exhibition by Galerie Mirchandani and Ranjana Steinruecke, marking the death anniversary of renowned artist Bhupen Khakhar. "Bhupen was one of the first artists to have used pink liberally in his art works. This show attempts to decipher the meaning of the colour in India," says Steinruecke. Complementing Khakhar's experiments with bright colours, the collection will comprise installations by American artist Polly Apfelbaum, abstracts by Yogesh Rawal and works by Sudarshan Shetty, Tushar Jog, Bharti Kher, Anandajit Ray, Shahzia Sikander, Thukral and Tagra and Arpita Singh. "The show was inspired by the ideas connected with pink in India. Unlike the connotations pink has in the West, it is closely associated with the history, lives and architecture of the country," adds Steinruecke. From August 8 to September 8.

by Swati Mathur

An exhibit from the show



art

Freedom Show

DELHI Ati Art Gallery presents 'Independent India: An Art Show of the New Era Artists', a group exhibition of more than 40 works in acrylic, oil and mixed media on canvas. The artists portray their interpretation of modern independent India. The show will also travel to



A work by Asit Patnaik

Bangalore in September. On at Alliance Francaise de Delhi. From August 11 to 13.